



Historic: Vinesh Phogat took down defending champion Yui Susaki in her opening bout at the Paris Olympics. The Japanese wrestler had not lost an international bout in her professional career. REUTERS

wrestler she had beaten comfortably just a month before. Now, in Paris, another poor weight cut left her at the lowest point of her wrestling career.

Her battles, though, haven't been restricted to the mat. Perhaps the most significant one Vinesh has fought has been for the safety of

young girls in the sport. In pursuing this fight, she took on one of the most powerful men in Indian sports — Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh.

When her rivals were preparing for the Olympics, Vinesh was fighting on the streets of New Delhi, where she, and few other fellow wrestlers,

accused Brij Bhushan, a five-time member of parliament and the long-time president of the Wrestling Federation, of sexual harassment.

The longer she stayed on the streets, the slimmer her chances on the mat became. Yet, she continued to prioritise what she felt was right.

« Vinesh has stood firm, challenging the system without regard for the consequences »